Finding Value in Small Software Acquisitions

What 1,000 revenue-verified listings show about where the assets are and what they actually cost

262	$86.8M	2.3x	4.75x
listings for sale	total asked	median quoted multiple	the real one

Session 3: AI for Business
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Only the money is verified. Everything describing the business is not.

Founders connect a payment-provider API key, so revenue cannot be self-reported. Every other field can be.

Verified by the payment API

30-day, 3-month, 12-month, all-time revenue

Monthly recurring revenue

Active subscriptions

Revenue and MRR growth

Payment provider

Declared by the seller or scraped

Company name — 130 listings publish none

Country — blank on 241

Category and market tags — blank on 274

Asking price and revenue multiple

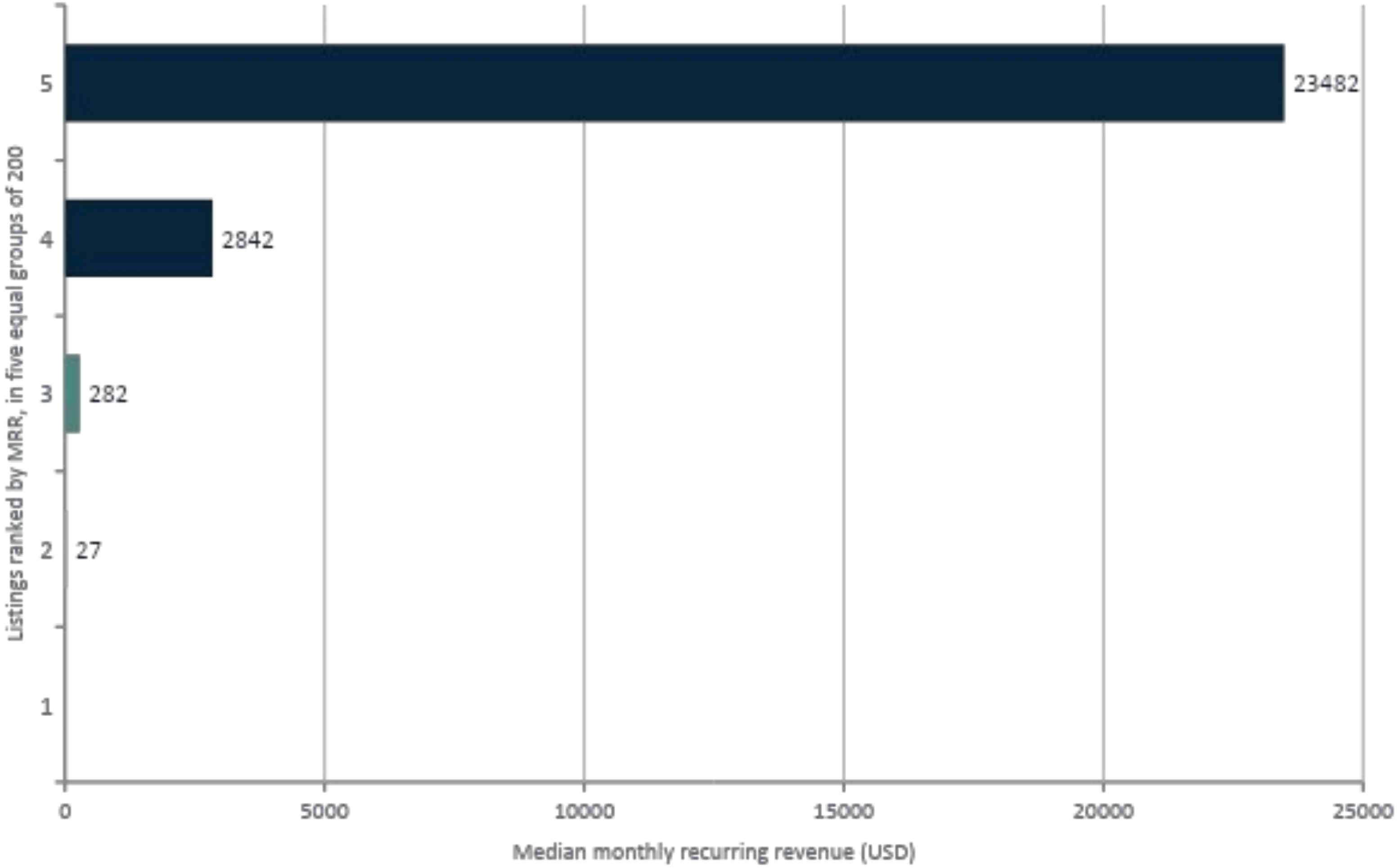
Followers, domain rating, site visitors

Diligence rule: price the left column, discount the right one.

Sellers control every field a buyer instinctively reads first — the name, the category, the story. None of it is audited.

The typical listing earns $282 a month. The average earns $13,472.

A 48x gap. Use medians throughout — the mean here describes about eleven companies.



48x

gap between mean and median MRR

197

listings report $0 MRR and zero subscriptions

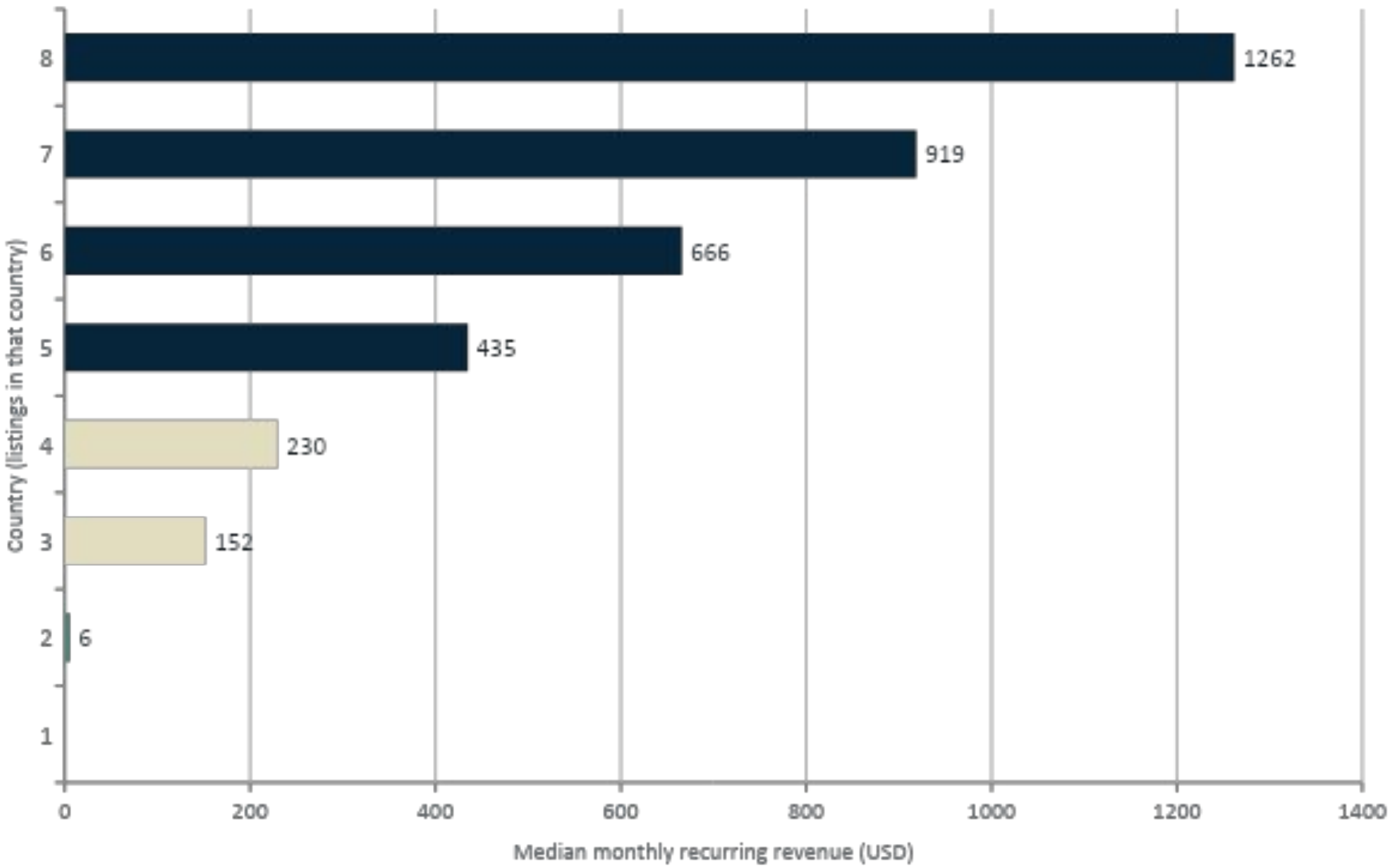
81.8%

of all revenue sits in the top 100 listings

Any average quoted from this market is quoting its outliers.

Country screens harder than any category label: $1,262 in the US, $6 in India.

A 210x spread on medians. The widest spread across all 31 market tags is 27x.



55.7%

of all revenue sits in 258 US listings

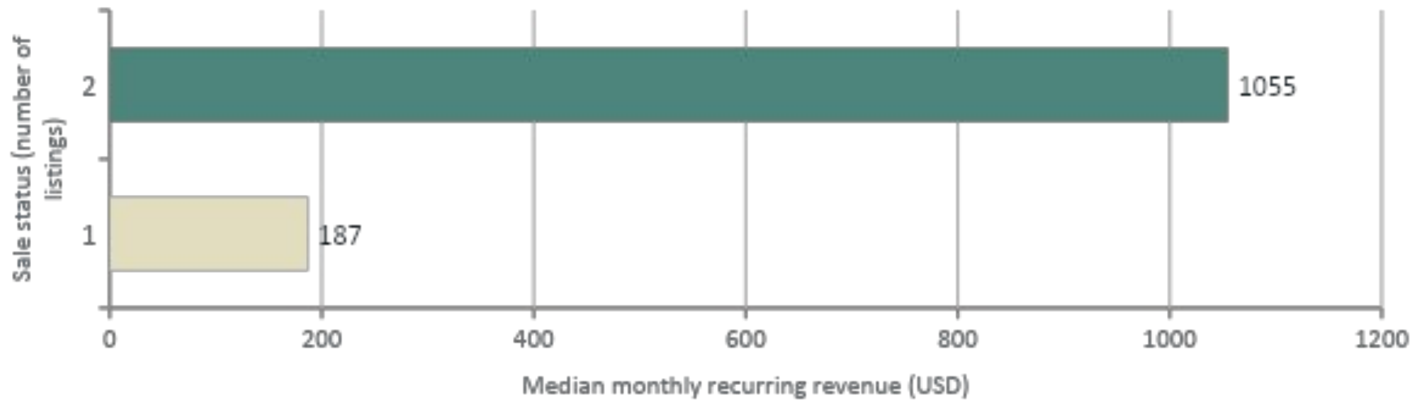
210x

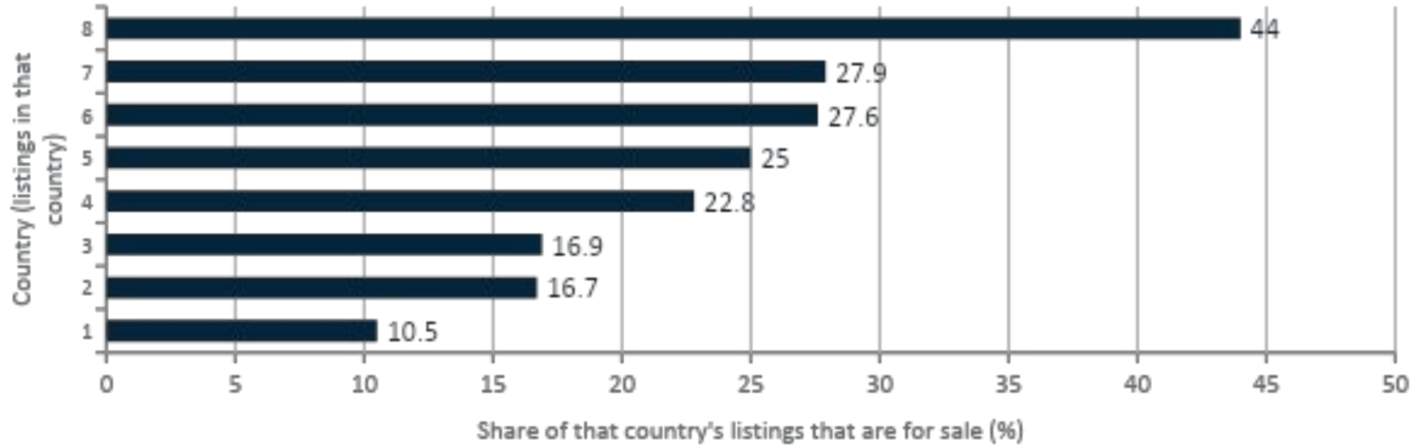
US-to-India gap on medians. On means it is only 11x — averages hide it.

Screen on country first. It costs nothing and removes more weak listings than any category filter.

You are competing for assets, not picking up distressed ones.

Listings for sale earn 5.6x the median of those not for sale. This is not a scrapyard.





5.6x

sellers out-earn non-sellers at the median

44.0%

of UK listings are for sale — the highest rate of any measurable country, against 26.2% overall

Founders with working businesses are the ones exiting. Expect competition and priced-in quality — underwrite accordingly.

Every quoted multiple is built on a single month.

206 of 217 priced listings reconcile to asking price ÷ (30-day revenue × 12). Only 4 reconcile against the trailing year.

59.5%

of listings on sale have 12-month revenue equal to all-time revenue — under a year old

44.8%

of sellers reporting growth moved exactly 0.0% last month

37

listings report $0 MRR and still ask a median $3,000

A multiple anchored to a single month inherits that month's noise — in a market where nearly half of sellers moved 0.0%.

Diligence rule

Never accept the quoted multiple. Re-derive it on 12-month revenue before making an offer — slide 07 shows what that does to the number.

$86.8M

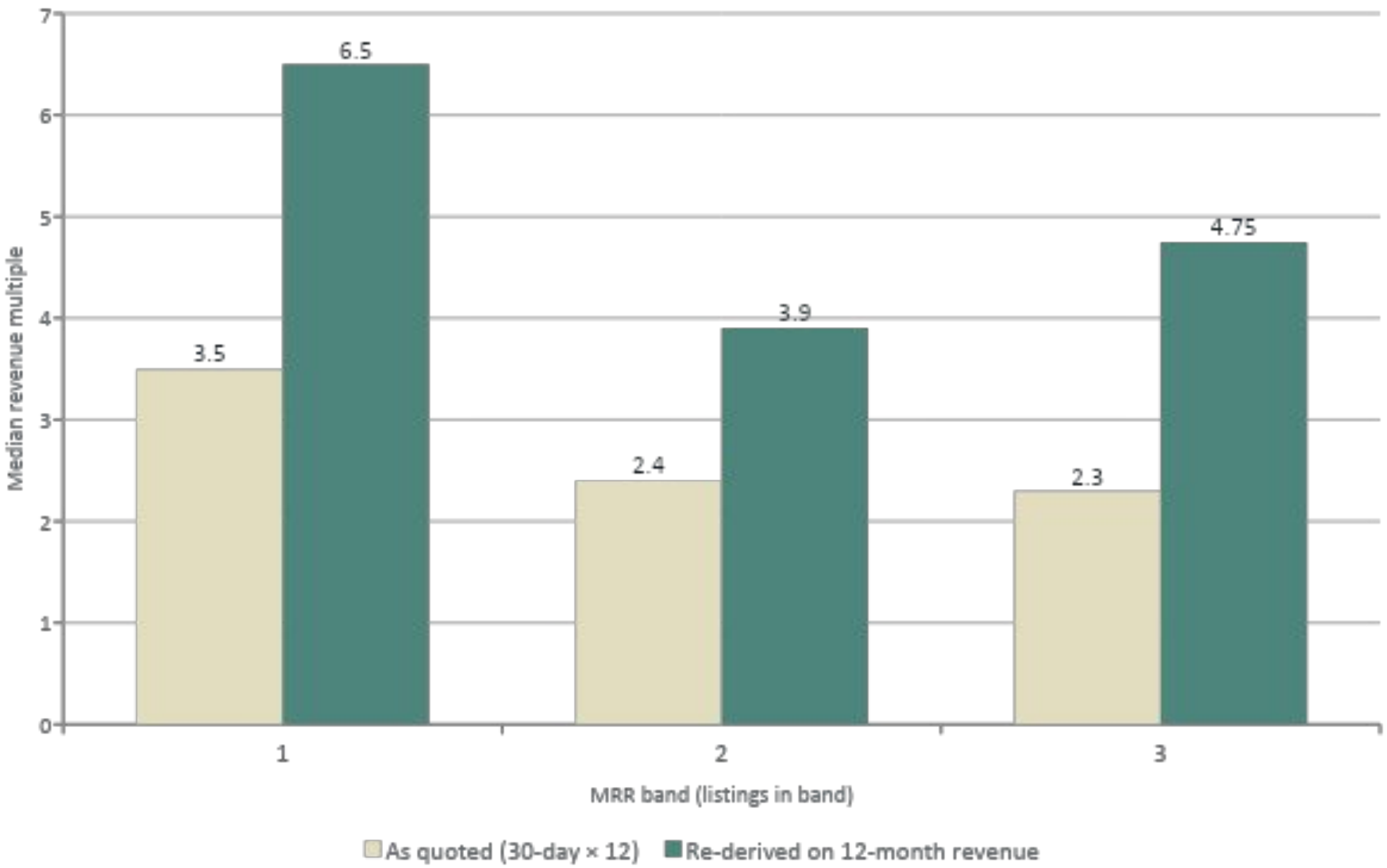
total asked across all 262 listings

$35,000

median asking price

Re-derived on the trailing year, the market's 2.3x is really 4.75x.

64% of priced listings are more expensive than they appear, and the small end is where the gap is worst.



2.07x

the true cost against the quoted one, at the median

6.5x

real multiple on sub-$1,000 listings — the cheapest assets are the most overpriced

Reject the sub-$1,000 band outright unless the seller can evidence a year of revenue.